

Impact High · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

Name the rupture lightly -> Take your part -> Reopen the door

START HERE

Name the fact that the last conversation was difficult — without over-explaining it — and say you want to move forward.

SAY THIS

Repair Openers	<i>"Last time was harder than I wanted it to be."</i>
Ownership Phrases	<i>"The part I can own is that I came in too hot."</i>
Door Openers	<i>"I would like us to be all right again."</i>
Workplace Repair	<i>"Before we move on to today's agenda, I want to clear the air about last week."</i>
Serious Ruptures	<i>"I know an apology does not undo it. I want to say it anyway."</i>

AVOID

- When the other person needs space and is not ready to engage — forcing a repair can inflame.
- When you have no genuine ownership to take — empty apologies make ruptures worse.
- When the friction was minor and naming it formally elevates it unnecessarily.

REMEMBER

Repair the way it was said before what was said.